

INTERNATIONAL AS PSYCHOLOGY

PS01

Unit 1 Introductory Topics in Psychology

Mark scheme

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Version: 1.0 Final



2 4 6 X P S 0 1 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

Further copies of this mark scheme are available from www.oxfordaqa.com

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Level of response marking instructions

Level of response mark schemes are broken down into levels, each of which has a descriptor. The descriptor for the level shows the average performance for the level. There are marks in each level.

Before you apply the mark scheme to a student's answer read through the answer and annotate it (as instructed) to show the qualities that are being looked for. You can then apply the mark scheme.

Step 1 Determine a level

Start at the lowest level of the mark scheme and use it as a ladder to see whether the answer meets the descriptor for that level. The descriptor for the level indicates the different qualities that might be seen in the student's answer for that level. If it meets the lowest level then go to the next one and decide if it meets this level, and so on, until you have a match between the level descriptor and the answer. With practice and familiarity you will find that for better answers you will be able to quickly skip through the lower levels of the mark scheme.

When assigning a level you should look at the overall quality of the answer and not look to pick holes in small and specific parts of the answer where the student has not performed quite as well as the rest. If the answer covers different aspects of different levels of the mark scheme you should use a best fit approach for defining the level and then use the variability of the response to help decide the mark within the level, ie if the response is predominantly level 3 with a small amount of level 4 material it would be placed in level 3 but be awarded a mark near the top of the level because of the level 4 content.

Step 2 Determine a mark

Once you have assigned a level you need to decide on the mark. The descriptors on how to allocate marks can help with this. The exemplar materials used during standardisation will help. There will be an answer in the standardising materials which will correspond with each level of the mark scheme. This answer will have been awarded a mark by the Lead Examiner. You can compare the student's answer with the example to determine if it is the same standard, better or worse than the example. You can then use this to allocate a mark for the answer based on the Lead Examiner's mark on the example.

You may well need to read back through the answer as you apply the mark scheme to clarify points and assure yourself that the level and the mark are appropriate.

Indicative content in the mark scheme is provided as a guide for examiners. It is not intended to be exhaustive and you must credit other valid points. Students do not have to cover all of the points mentioned in the Indicative content to reach the highest level of the mark scheme.

An answer which contains nothing of relevance to the question must be awarded no marks.

Section A: Memory**Total for this section: 30 marks**

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
01	Outline the capacity of short-term memory. Award 1 mark for a correct outline of the capacity of STM. The capacity of short-term memory is 7 +/-2 (5–9) items/words/numbers. Note: No credit for simply stating that capacity is limited.	1 AO1 = 1

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
02	Researchers have found that the duration of short-term memory is between 15 and 30 seconds. Describe how the duration of short-term memory has been investigated. Award marks as follows 3 marks: The explanation of how the duration of short-term memory has been investigated is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks: The explanation of how the duration of short-term memory has been investigated lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark: The explanation of how the duration of short-term memory has been investigated is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible content • Participants are presented with nonsense trigrams (eg HBK). • After each nonsense trigram participants are asked to count backwards in threes from a starting number. • Participants are asked to count backwards for different amounts of time, 3 seconds, 6 seconds, 9 seconds and so on. • Participants are asked to recall the nonsense trigram as soon as they stop counting backwards in threes. • Researchers measured duration based on the accuracy of the recalled nonsense trigram. Credit other procedures that test the duration of short-term memory.	3 AO1 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
03	Aamna and Rayan are talking about revision for their examinations. Aamna says, “I struggle to revise. I read my notes once, but the next day I can’t remember what I have revised. My father likes to play loud music and I can’t concentrate.” Rayan says, “I find revising easy. I work in a quiet room, read my notes several times and then do practice questions to see if I have remembered the information. I can remember the information for weeks, if not longer.” Using your knowledge of the multi-store model of memory, explain the conversation between Aamna and Rayan. Possible application • Aamna reads her notes once and therefore does not rehearse the information. Rayan reads her notes lots of times and therefore rehearses the information. (Rehearsal is essential in the multi-store model). • Aamna cannot recall information the next day, suggesting it is lost from STM where the duration is 15–30 seconds. • Rayan can recall information for weeks or longer, showing information has moved to LTM which has a duration of up to a lifetime. • Aamna is distracted by the loud music her dad plays, this may prevent rehearsal or her paying attention or acoustic encoding in STM, any of these are vital for remembering information according to the multi-store model. • Rayan completes practice questions which retrieve information from LTM back to STM. This helps to reinforce the memory trace as the information is reprocessed through the rehearsal loop. Credit other relevant material. Note: Maximum of 3 marks if only one person is addressed. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>The application of the multi-store model to Aamna and Rayan is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>The application of the multi-store model to Aamna and/or Rayan is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	The application of the multi-store model to Aamna and Rayan is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	The application of the multi-store model to Aamna and/or Rayan is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO2 = 4
Level	Description	Marks												
2	The application of the multi-store model to Aamna and Rayan is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4												
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0	No creditable content.	0												

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
04	Explain one limitation of the multi-store model of memory. Award marks as follows 3 marks: The limitation of multi-store model is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks: The limitation of multi-store model lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark: The limitation of multi-store model is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible content • Considered oversimplified as the model suggests information is processed in a linear way. • Suggests STM is a singular store. Research such as that into the WMM (Baddeley and Hitch, 1974) or case studies (KF) show that STM may be divided into more than one store. • Suggests LTM is a singular store. Research into LTM shows multiple stores such as semantic, episodic and procedural. • Suggests rehearsal is essential to remembering. Meaningful information does not always need to be rehearsed (flashbulb memories, levels of processing model (Craik and Lockhart, 1972)). • Much of the underlying research evidence lacks validity due to artificial stimuli/environment, eg learning word lists, which does not reflect how most of our memory functions in real-life. Credit other relevant material. Note: Any methodological limitations of studies can only be credited if related to the multi-store model.	3 AO3 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
05	Briefly describe the episodic buffer and the visuo-spatial sketchpad. For each of the components award marks as follows: 2 marks for a clear description of the component. 1 mark for a muddled or vague description of the component. Possible content Episodic buffer • Links the central executive and working memory to LTM. • Temporary store, sub-system to the central executive. • Processes all types of information. • Keeps information in sequence. • Helps us to recall events. • Has a limited capacity. Visuo-spatial sketchpad • Processes what we see (visual) and where we are/location (spatial) information. • Temporary store, sub-system to the central executive. • Has two parts, the inner scribe which processes spatial information and the visual cache which processes and stores visual information, eg colour, shape. • Has a limited capacity. Credit other relevant material. Note: Credit references to limited capacity only once.	4 AO1 = 4

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
06	Identify the type of long-term memory described below. Being able to remember the date of your friend's birthday. Shade one box only. Answer key: C – Semantic Memory	1 AO1 = 1

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
07.1	Norman and Abdul witnessed a man in a blue jacket take a phone from a shop without paying for it. They reported this to the manager of the shop. While waiting for the police to arrive, Norman and Abdul were talking about what happened and Abdul said, “The man was wearing a black jacket.” The manager took Abdul into a small room and asked him what had happened. Abdul said, “A man wearing a black jacket took a phone from your shop.” After speaking to Abdul, the manager spoke to Norman and asked him, “Did you see the man in the black jacket take the phone?” State two factors that might have affected Norman’s eyewitness testimony. Award marks as follows 1 mark: for leading questions/misleading information. 1 mark: for post-event discussion. Accept anxiety as a possible factor that could have affected Norman’s eyewitness testimony, although there is no detail of this in the scenario.	2 AO2 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
07.2	Briefly explain how one of the factors identified in Question 7.1 might have affected Norman’s eyewitness testimony. Award marks as follows 2 marks for a clear application of one explicit factor that affects eyewitness testimony. 1 mark for a muddled or vague/implicit application of one factor that affects eyewitness testimony. Possible content Post-event discussion • Norman and Abdul’s conversation is likely to decrease the accuracy of Norman’s recall. • When talking to Norman, Abdul mentions the man wearing a black jacket rather than a blue jacket, which will affect Norman’s memory of the event. OR Leading questions • The question from the manager may cause Norman to give inaccurate eyewitness testimony about the event. • The question contains inaccurate information about the colour of the jacket the man was wearing. Accept alternative wording.	2 AO2 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
08.1	Describe the cognitive interview. Possible content • An interview technique devised to improve the accuracy of witness recall. • Witnesses asked to think about the crime and consider things such as where they were, the weather, what happened before/after. Helps to reduce anxiety and allows thinking time before giving details to the police. (Context reinstatement) • The witness recalls all details, however minor, from the beginning to the end. This increases the amount of information recalled, helps it to be recalled in chronological order and helps the police to piece together the crime more effectively. (Report everything) • The witness recalls the event from the perspective from another witness/person involved. This helps the police to see how different witnesses may have seen different variations of an event but also helps to reduce the impact of schemas. (Recall from a changed perspective) • The witness recalls the event backwards. Helps to reduce the influence of schemas and encourages the witness to think about the event in more depth. (Recall in reverse order) Credit other relevant material including information about the enhanced cognitive interview. Note: Maximum of 1 mark for just naming several techniques used in the cognitive interview. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>The description of the cognitive interview is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>The description of the cognitive interview is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	The description of the cognitive interview is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	The description of the cognitive interview is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO1 = 4
Level	Description	Marks												
2	The description of the cognitive interview is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4												
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks															
08.2	Evaluate the cognitive interview. Possible evaluation - Many research studies (eg Kohnken 1999 meta-analysis) show the cognitive interview increases the accuracy of eyewitness testimony when compared to a standard interview. - Although the amount of correct information has been found to increase, there is also an increase in incorrect information recalled (Kohnken, 1999). - Recall in reverse order and recall from a changed perspective have been found to increase the amount of information, but context reinstatement and report everything on their own are the best combination (Milne and Bull, 2002). - Does not work well with children under six due to their imaginations. (Geiselman, 1999). - Decreases anxiety of the witness due to the cognitive reinstatement section, meaning the testimony should be more accurate as anxiety decreases the accuracy of memory. - Reduces the influence of leading questions as direct questions are limited. - Time consuming, when it was introduced the police spent considerable amounts of time interviewing. - Police must be trained in delivering the interview technique and this training takes time and requires funding. Credit other relevant material, such as the enhanced cognitive interview and self-administered interview. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Evaluation of the cognitive interview is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of terminology.</td><td>5–6</td></tr> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Evaluation of the cognitive interview is relevant but detail is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Evaluation of the cognitive interview is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	3	Evaluation of the cognitive interview is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of terminology.	5–6	2	Evaluation of the cognitive interview is relevant but detail is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	3–4	1	Evaluation of the cognitive interview is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	6 AO3 = 6
Level	Description	Marks															
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Section B: Social Psychology**Total for this section: 30 marks**

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
09	Outline the findings of Asch's investigation into the effects of group size on conformity. Award marks as follows 3 marks the outline of Asch's findings into the effects of group size on conformity. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks the outline of Asch's findings into the effects of group size on conformity lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark the outline of Asch's findings into the effects of group size on conformity is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible content • Asch found that as the group size increased (to a point) and there were more confederates, the average conformity levels of the participants tended to increase. • When there was one confederate there was a very low average conformity rate (3%). • Two confederates had a higher average conformity rate than when there was only one confederate (13%). • Three confederates had higher average conformity rates than one or two (33%). • More than three confederates did not change the average conformity rate significantly more. Three confederates had a similar average conformity rate to Asch's original research. • 15 or more confederates were found to have a slightly lower average conformity rate than three confederates.	3 AO1 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
10	Explain one limitation of Asch’s investigations into conformity. Award marks as follows 3 marks the limitation of Asch’s investigations is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks the limitation of Asch’s investigations lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark the limitation of Asch’s investigations is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible limitations • Research is highly artificial and as a result lacks ecological validity. Participants are not asked to answer questions based on line length in everyday life. • The research is conducted on limited samples. For example, all male participants, college students. • Asch’s study is a “Child of its time” due to McCarthyism in the USA (1950s). Participants may have conformed more as this was a time when conformity was the norm so may not apply to other times (temporal validity). • Research was carried out in the USA so findings were affected by the attitudes/norms at the time so may not apply to other cultures (cultural validity). • Ethical issues, for example deception, lack of informed consent, lack of protection from harm and lack of right to withdraw. • Further research (Perrin and Spencer, 1984) does not replicate the results, eg it was found 1 participant out of 396 conformed once. Credit other relevant material.	3 AO3 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
11	John and Rebecca are going to run a marathon in 6 months' time with a running group from work. The running group has a training plan that says they must run every day during their lunch break at work. John and Rebecca are discussing the training plan. John says, "I would prefer to relax in my lunch break. However, I do not want to be left out. I like the people in the running group, so I will follow the training plan like everyone else." Rebecca says, "At first, I was not sure how to train for the marathon, but I'm going to follow the training plan. It will be a good way of getting ready for the marathon." Using your knowledge of explanations for conformity, explain the conversation between John and Rebecca. Possible content • Rebecca believes the running group knows how to train for the marathon, as she did not know herself. (Informational influence) • Rebecca now believes that the training plan is a good way of getting ready for the marathon so demonstrates internalisation. • John wants to fit in with the running group. (Normative influence) • John is complying with the group training plan by running at lunchtime, even though he would rather relax during the lunch break. Credit other relevant material. Note: Maximum of 3 marks if only one person is addressed. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>The application of the explanations for conformity to Rebecca and John is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>The application of the explanations for conformity to Rebecca and/or John is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	The application of the explanations for conformity to Rebecca and John is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	The application of the explanations for conformity to Rebecca and/or John is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO2 = 4
Level	Description	Marks												
2	The application of the explanations for conformity to Rebecca and John is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4												
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks															
12	Evaluate explanations for conformity. Possible evaluation Normative Influence (NI) - Individual differences may determine why someone conforms rather than the particular situation, eg some people have a need for affiliation and as a result are more likely to conform due to NI (McGhee, 1957). - NI may not be detected by individuals and therefore it may be more influential than research shows (Nolan, 2008). - Use of supporting evidence for the existence of NI, eg Asch (1955), Mori and Arai (2010). Informational Influence (II) - Use of supporting evidence for the existence of II, eg Lucas et al (2006), Jenness (1932). - II is influenced by whether something is fact or opinion. II is more likely to occur when an answer is subjective (Laughlin, 1999). Other evaluation points - The two-process approach of conformity being down to either NI or II is over simplistic. Both processes (dual process dependency model) are likely to be involved and it can be difficult to isolate the effect of each in experimentation. - Issues with the reliability of the findings of research meaning the explanations of conformity are weakened, eg use of artificial situations and laboratory experiments, use of artificial tasks, issues with samples related to generalisability etc. Credit other relevant material. Note: Methodological points must be linked to why it limits the explanation of conformity to gain credit. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Evaluation of explanations of conformity is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of terminology.</td><td>5–6</td></tr> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Evaluation of explanations of conformity is relevant but detail is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Evaluation of explanations of conformity is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	3	Evaluation of explanations of conformity is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of terminology.	5–6	2	Evaluation of explanations of conformity is relevant but detail is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	3–4	1	Evaluation of explanations of conformity is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	6 AO3 = 6
Level	Description	Marks															
3	Evaluation of explanations of conformity is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of terminology.	5–6															
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0	No creditable content.	0															

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
13	Briefly explain the agentic state as an explanation for obedience. Award marks as follows 2 marks for a clear explanation of the agentic state. 1 mark for a muddled or vague explanation of the agentic state. Possible content • The agentic state is where the individual feels as though they are not responsible for their actions, therefore acting as an agent for the authority figure. • The individual moves from an autonomous state to acting as an agent for the authority figure. • The individual believes that the authority figure is responsible for the individual's actions. Credit other relevant material.	2 AO1 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks									
14	Discuss locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence. Possible content • There are two types of locus of control, internal and external. • People with an internal locus of control believe they control their own lives and are less concerned with social approval. • People with an internal locus of control are more likely to resist the pressure to conform. • People with an internal locus of control are less likely to obey and/or conform than those with an external locus of control. • People with an external locus of control have the opposite traits to those with internal locus of control, they are more likely to conform/obey so do not tend to resist social influence. • Locus of control is assessed by questionnaire (Rotter, 1966). Possible discussion • Research into locus of control suggests that those with internal locus of control are more likely to question requests that are made of them (Oliner and Oliner, 1988). • Problems of using questionnaires to assess personality traits like locus of control as participants may give socially desirable answers that result in invalid measures of their personality. • Research evidence to support, eg Elms and Milgram, 1974. • Research by Twenge (2004) suggests people have become more external but are actually more likely to resist social influence. • Discussion/analysis of different forms of resistance, eg independent behaviour vs anti-conformity. • Comparison with other explanations of resisting social influence, for example social support. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>4</td><td>Discussion of locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence is mostly effective. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear, organised and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.</td><td>10–12</td></tr> <tr> <td>3</td><td>There is some effective discussion of locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.</td><td>7–9</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	4	Discussion of locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence is mostly effective. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear, organised and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.	10–12	3	There is some effective discussion of locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.	7–9	12 AO1 = 6 AO3 = 6
Level	Description	Marks									
4	Discussion of locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence is mostly effective. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear, organised and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.	10–12									
3	There is some effective discussion of locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.	7–9									

	2	Discussion of locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence is of limited effectiveness. The answer lacks clarity, accuracy and organisation in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	4–6
	1	Discussion of locus of control as an explanation of resistance to social influence is limited and poorly focused. The answer as a whole lacks clarity, has many inaccuracies and is poorly organised. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–3
	0	No creditable content.	0

Section C: Psychopathology

Total for this section: 30 marks

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
15	Monik has a phobia of cats. He believes that all cats are dangerous and will hurt him. Monik worries he will see a cat and he will not visit his friends if they have one. When Monik sees a cat, his heart rate increases, he starts to sweat and he runs away from it. Explain three characteristics of phobias shown by Monik. For any three of the following characteristics, award marks as follows 2 marks for a clear explanation of a characteristic of phobias applied to Monik's behaviour. 1 mark for a muddled or vague explanation of a characteristic of phobias applied to Monik's behaviour. Possible application • Monik displays anxiety, he is worrying about seeing a cat. He shows signs of anxiety as his heart rate increases and he sweats when he sees them. • Monik displays irrational thoughts about cats, he believes that all cats will hurt him and that they are dangerous, eg catastrophic thinking. • Monik displays avoidance behaviour, he will not visit his friends who have cats and runs away if he sees one. • Monik displays physical symptoms of an increased heart rate and sweating, suggesting he is fearful. Note: A maximum of 1 mark should be awarded for simply naming one or more relevant characteristics of phobias.	6 AO2 = 6

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
16	Describe flooding as a treatment for phobias. Possible content • Flooding is based on classical conditioning and breaking the CS-CR bond causing extinction of the phobia (implosion). If we have learnt via association we can unlearn via association. • Flooding does this with rapid conditioning, a sudden and full exposure to the phobic situation. This is an intense form of exposure therapy. • The individual is unable to escape the phobia (prevention of avoidance) which causes a patient's anxiety levels to rise but these will eventually reduce/subside as anxiety cannot remain high indefinitely (Yerkes-Dodson law). • When anxiety levels reduce the association between the stimulus and anxiety is broken (ie becomes extinct), therefore helping to treat the phobia. • Can be done in vivo/in vitro. (It is generally found that flooding completed in vivo is more effective at treating phobias). Credit other relevant material. Note: Credit the use of examples to describe flooding as a treatment for phobias. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>The description of flooding as a treatment for phobias is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>The description of flooding as a treatment for phobias is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	The description of flooding as a treatment for phobias is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	The description of flooding as a treatment for phobias is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO1 = 4
Level	Description	Marks												
2	The description of flooding as a treatment for phobias is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4												
1	The description of flooding as a treatment for phobias is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2												
0	No creditable content.	0												

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
17	Describe and evaluate cognitive explanations of depression. Possible content • The general rationale of the cognitive explanation of depression is that negative/disturbed thoughts are the cause of depression. • Beck's negative triad suggests that negative schema lead to negative perceptions/pessimistic thinking. • Beck's negative triad focuses on negative views of the self, world and future. • Aspects of negative thoughts, eg overgeneralisation, magnification, selective perception, absolutist thinking. • Ellis's ABC model, eg A is the activating negative event; B is the belief about why the negative event happened; C is the consequence, feeling depressed. • Depressed people make internal, stable and global attributions about negative events (attributional style). Possible evaluation • Use of evidence to support/refute cognitive explanations (eg Alloy, 1975, Hammen and Krantz, 1976, Lloyd and Lishman, 1975). • Cognitive explanations provide insight into thinking processes involved with depression, whereas some theories ignore thought processes. • Not all negative thinking is irrational, some people may be too positive. Depressive realism is not considered to be irrational but rather more in line with reality. • The explanation has enabled the development of cognitive therapies such as CBT (cognitive behavioural therapy), which is used successfully to treat depression. • Not all depression occurs after an activating event (as Ellis would expect), criticising the basis on the activating event element of the theory. • Establishing cause and effect can be an issue for the explanation as the thoughts may be the cause but also may simply be the effect of other factors linked to depression. • Cognitive explanations do not explain all aspects of depression, eg anger, delusions in bipolar. • Lack of consideration for biological factors in depression. Low levels of serotonin are correlated with the disorder and anti-depressants are prescribed to treat depression. • Comparison with other possible explanations, eg that depression might be inherited. Credit other relevant material. Note: If only one cognitive explanation of depression is present a maximum of level 3 can be credited.	20 AO1 = 8 AO3 = 12

	Level	Description	Marks	
	4	Knowledge of cognitive explanations of depression is mostly accurate and generally well detailed. Discussion is mostly effective. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.	16–20	
	3	Knowledge of cognitive explanation(s) of depression is evident but there are occasional inaccuracies/omissions. There is some effective discussion. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.	11–15	
	2	Limited knowledge of cognitive explanation(s) of depression is present. Any discussion is of limited effectiveness. The answer lacks clarity, accuracy and organisation in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	6–10	
	1	Knowledge of cognitive explanation(s) of depression is very limited. Discussion is limited, poorly focused or absent. The answer as a whole lacks clarity, has many inaccuracies and is poorly organised. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–5	
	0	No creditable content.	0	